

The 13-Day Planning System

Inspired by the Mayan Calendar and Agile project management systems

A couple of years ago, I was faced with the Mayan Calendar. As soon as a huge project was in my plans, I decided to lay out all the tasks required to complete it into a system. I was searching for a work calendar that would keep me on track. There were two tasks: the first was to complete the project on time, and the second was to keep a balance between my work and my family.

I have a huge amount of experience as an entrepreneur, especially in the IT field, and I have practiced Agile project management, such as Scrum. As soon as I found natural cycles from Mayan calendar, I thought they could be useful: to keep focus on the project, to balance with other tasks and my family. Every time I know, whenever I do, I can complete the main goal for today and be happy with that. Sometimes it takes your efforts to choose your path for the next 13 days and plan all the tasks to complete. Sometimes it is easy and takes no more than 15 minutes a day. But anytime you know your purpose for keeping focused, and you're happy with tracking progress.

At the time, when a lot of people see a lot of mystery in that, I see a lot of psychology as well: you set your goal, you have doubts, you act, you show your result to others, you complete everything, and without trying to make everything ideal, you release it to the public. Afterall, you have time to see the results, adjust and reflect, without diving into another task until a new sprint starts.

Natural tones as a productive system

In the Mayan system, there are 13 natural tones, each of which is responsible for a day. In our case, each one is responsible for each sprint step.

Some people ask, why is it only 13 and not just exactly two weeks. I could refer back to Maya (they used to live like this for a hundred years), but I will say so: the fact that you do not have a strict weekday for something exact, makes you NOT feel this process as Groundhog Day with a repetitive story. And that is important when you move sprints, but over a long distance.

I've also noticed that the proper energy and a mood for the next step tomorrow... comes the day before, after sunset. That thought is mentioned in the Mayan Calender but also quite logical - you completed the task on one day, and your mind moves to another one.

How to use this book

1. Set your goal at the beginning of each sprint
 2. Follow the tips for each day and keep focus on the main goal
 3. Reflect on your results at the end of each sprint
-

Each day have it's own purpose

Tones 1-10 are more about reaching your goal:

Tone	Task	Purpose
1	Goal	Define the goal for the entire sprint. Choose carefully, you will need to stick to your goal during the whole sprint.
2	Challenge	You will face your doubt or a challenge from other people, which will probably make you unsure about your goal.
3	Activation	Take the first action on the project. You usually feel an energy to do first great steps.
4	Plan	Lock in the final plan and tasks. You probably thought about it already. Write it down. Do not hesitate to adjust.
5	Traction	The work is progressing. Show the first results to others from your team, friends, or family members.
6	Balance	Balance between sprint tasks and others. You probably have other obligations you need to complete or to spend time with your family.
7	Sync	Align with partners and the team. Collaborate. It is a great time to set up calls and meetings.
8	Focus	Stay true to your original intent while acting. Keep the progress.
9	Intention	Set the intention to act. Finalize preparation. Complete all the preparations. Now, remember why you chosed you goal on the first side. Write down your intention for tomorrow.
10	Action	Act, make sprint results available to everyone. Release to the public. Make it visible.

Tones 11-13 are about preparing for that next sprint:

Tone	Task	Purpose
11	Cleanup	Remove what's unnecessary. I was focusing on the progress and now it is time to clear your space and your mind.
12	Results	Write down the results achieved in this sprint. What was achieved? Why are you proud of yourself?
13	Reflection	Write down what you learned. No new tasks today. What was done right and what was wrong? Take a final rest before a new cycle.

Sprint

5 Jan – 17 Jan

① **Goal** - Define the goal for the entire sprint.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
① 5 Jan Goal	② 6 Jan Challenge	③ 7 Jan Activation	④ 8 Jan Plan	⑤ 9 Jan Traction	⑥ 10 Jan Balance	⑦ 11 Jan Sync
⑧ 12 Jan Focus	⑨ 13 Jan Intention	⑩ 14 Jan Action	⑪ 15 Jan Cleanup	⑫ 16 Jan Results	⑬ 17 Jan Reflection	

② **Challenge** - Write down the doubt or challenge you faced today.

③ **Activation** - Take the first action on the project.

④ **Plan Task List** - Lock in the final plan and tasks.

[illegible]

⑤ **Traction** - The work is progressing, show the first results.

⑥ **Balance** - Balance between sprint tasks and others.

⑦ **Sync** - Align with partners and the team. Collaborate.

⑧ **Focus** - Stay true to your original intent while acting.

⑨ **Intention** - Set the intention to act. Finalize preparation.

⑩ **Action** - Act, make sprint results available to everyone.

⑪ **Cleanup** - Clear space and mind. Remove what's unnecessary.

⑫ **Results** - Write down the results achieved in this sprint.

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

⑬ **Reflection** - Write down what you learned. No new tasks.

Sprint

18 Jan – 30 Jan

① **Goal** - Define the goal for the entire sprint.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
						① 18 Jan Goal
② 19 Jan Challenge	③ 20 Jan Activation	④ 21 Jan Plan	⑤ 22 Jan Traction	⑥ 23 Jan Balance	⑦ 24 Jan Sync	⑧ 25 Jan Focus
⑨ 26 Jan Intention	⑩ 27 Jan Action	⑪ 28 Jan Cleanup	⑫ 29 Jan Results	⑬ 30 Jan Reflection		

② **Challenge** - Write down the doubt or challenge you faced today.

③ **Activation** - Take the first action on the project.

④ **Plan Task List** - Lock in the final plan and tasks.

[illegible]

⑤ **Traction** - The work is progressing, show the first results.

⑥ **Balance** - Balance between sprint tasks and others.

⑦ **Sync** - Align with partners and the team. Collaborate.

⑧ **Focus** - Stay true to your original intent while acting.

⑨ **Intention** - Set the intention to act. Finalize preparation.

⑩ **Action** - Act, make sprint results available to everyone.

⑪ **Cleanup** - Clear space and mind. Remove what's unnecessary.

⑫ **Results** - Write down the results achieved in this sprint.

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

○

⑬ **Reflection** - Write down what you learned. No new tasks.
